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How to set up a task to be executed every X minutes on a Plesk server?

 Leonid Gukhman (/hc/en-us/profiles/360284720973-Leonid-Gukhman)
Updated 6 months ago

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Applicable to: Plesk for Linux Plesk for Windows

Question

How to set up a task to be executed:

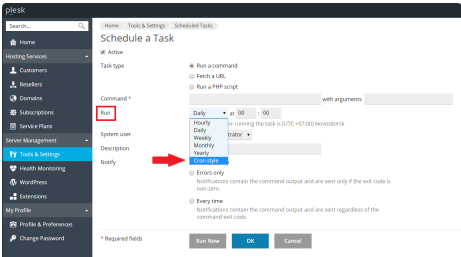
- every minute
- every 2 minutes
- every 5 minutes
- every 30 minutes

on a Plesk server?

Answer

The cron format for setting time of the task execution can be used.

1. Log in to Plesk (<https://support.plesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/213413369>).
2. Go to **Tools & Settings > Scheduled Tasks**, press the **Add Task** button to create a new task or click the already existing task.
3. Select the **Cron style** in the drop-down menu opposite the **Run** directive:



(https://support.plesk.com/hc/article_attachments/360032029554/screenshot.png)

4. Specify the required time in the cron format:

Note: using the "/" character is not allowed in Windows.

Instead of this, it's required to place a comma-separated list for each execution time.

If you try to use the "/" character, the next error will appear:

"Invalid crontab syntax"

Linux

- every minute:

* * * * *

- every 2 minutes:

to=https%3A%2F%2Fsupport.plesk.com%2Fhc%2Fen-us%2Farticles%2F115003372214-How-to-set-up-a-task-to-be-executed-every-X-minutes-on-a-Plesk-server-&locale=en-us)

Submit a request

every 5 minutes:

*/5 * * * *

every 30 minutes:

*/30 * * * *

Select Language ▼

Windows ▼



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Chad Thornburg (/hc/en-us/profiles/378225627434-Chad-Thornburg)

April 17, 2019 15:19

Hello! The example provided is not clear and only works because "every 30 minutes" is equivalent to two executions - at :00 and :30 of the hour. However, if you took this same command and wanted to edit it to every 2 minutes for example, somebody might try to use the cron-style (Windows): 0,2**** , but this is not correct. This would only run the task at :00 and :02 of the hour. To run a task every 2 minutes, you would need to use the following cron-style (Windows): 0,2,4,6,8,10,12,14,16,18,20,22,24,26,28,30,32,34,36,38,40,42,44,46,48,50,52,54,56,58 * * * *

Can you please review this article and update it if necessary to clarify the correct format for every x minutes?

Thanks!

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⬇

(/hc/en-us/signin?return_to=us%2Farti

⚙



Nikita Nikushkin

April 18, 2019 05:20

Hi @Chad Thornburg,

Indeed, using the "/" character is not allowed in Windows

Instead of this, it's required to place a comma-separated list for each execution time

If you try to use the "/" character, the next error will appear:

Invalid crontab syntax

So, your examples are correct and I added them to the article. Thank you!

⬆

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⬇

(/hc/en-us/signin?return_to=us%2Farti

⚙



Pete Batin (/hc/en-us/profiles/377030109994-Pete-Batin)

April 02, 2020 11:42

This was such a poorly thought out feature to implement and as such a bad one.

It's great that Plesk wants to standardise the control panel between platforms but now in the case of Windows servers the experience is worse than before. Previously there were checkboxes that you could tick, so if you wanted a task to execute every 5 minutes then you could just tick the appropriate boxes.

Now in attempt to bring cron style to Windows without the / character this has become really laborious having to enter 0,5,10,15,20,25,30,35,40,45,50,55 * * * *. There should have been compensation for the / character in Windows and Plesk should have translated this behind the scenes instead of the user. Plesk on Windows should detect the / character, work out the increments, produce a comma separated list and use that, the user should be unaware of this.

data=BAH7CioBZGVzdGluYXRob25fYXJ0aWNSZV9pZGwvCLFduMyAAdoYcmVmZXJyZXJfYXJ0aWNSZV9pZGwvCLYvYmMyAAdoLbG9iYWxlSSIKZW4tdXMGOgZFVDoldJXsSSJil2hil2VuLVXzL2FvdGlibC

